



Rating
Buy

North America
United States

Consumer
Autos & Auto Technology

Company
Tesla Inc.

Reuters
TSLA.OQ

Bloomberg
TSLA US

Exchange
NMS

Ticker
TSLA

Date
15 July 2026

Company Update

Price at 14 Jul 2026 (USD)	396.18
Price target	465.00
52-week range	489.88 - 21.00

2Q26 Preview

2Q26 earnings

Following 2Q deliveries which were significantly above expectations at ~480k units, we now model auto gross margin ex-credit at 18.0%, still down 120bps sequentially despite growing volume meaningfully QoQ. Going from 1Q to 2Q, the quarter should see incremental benefits from higher volume and increase in FSD monthly subscriptions. However, we also see some meaningful sequential headwinds:

- The first is that Tesla started offering 0.99% APR financing for Model Y in the US from May 10-31, likely benefiting unit volume at the expense of margins. If we assume 45k units sold in the US took advantage of the promotional rate, at around \$4k upfront rate buy-down cost to the partner bank, this would equate to \$180m hit to profit.
- Secondly, the company had benefited from a one-time warranty and tariff relief, collectively worth \$230m in 1Q. We estimate that the warranty amount is larger at about \$150m, and an unwind of that will be a QoQ headwind to 2Q. Tesla also did not realize any benefit from prior Supreme Court ruling on IEEPA tariffs, thus we're carrying the remaining \$80m into 2Q.
- Lastly, Tesla eliminated its upfront purchase of FSD back in mid-February, with 2Q being impacted on a full-quarter basis and we estimate about - \$200m in headwind.

All in, we estimate that GAAP auto gross margin will be about 19.2% in 2Q, vs. 21.1% in 1Q, with auto gross margin ex-credit estimated at 18.0% (down from 19.2%). All this leads to our adjusted EPS estimate of \$0.36, vs. consensus at \$0.47. For the full year, we think Tesla can grow volume by MSD to HSD %, and we now estimate 1.77m units, vs. 1.63m last year.

Valuation & Risks

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Key changes

EPS (USD)	1.35 to 1.58	↑	16.3%
Revenue (USDm)	97,076.2 to 105,167.7	↑	8.3%

Source: Deutsche Bank

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Figure 1: 2Q26E Gross Profit (ex-credit)
Walk

1Q26 Gross Profit (ex-credit)	3,042
Volume	1,045
Pricing/incentives	(180)
Warranty benefit unwind	(150)
FSD upfront purchase elimination	(200)
Increase in FSD / subscriptions	150
Manufacturing efficiencies	100
Others	(4)
2Q26E Gross Profit (ex-credit)	3,703

Source : Deutsche Bank Research

Robotaxi and Cybercab

Progress in the rollout of Tesla's robotaxi service has admittedly been slower than expected this year. While Tesla doesn't regularly disclose fleet size, public reporting suggests operations remain concentrated primarily in Austin but expansion has reached several additional metro areas including Bay Area, Dallas, and Houston. So far, no major crashes have been reported in Austin's commercial service which is positive for further geo-expansion. Main issue we have been observing is wait time which is perhaps linked to vehicle availability, and its ability to support high ride volumes. We continue to watch for fleet growth, geographic expansion rate, utilization, and in some cases, intervention rate. On Cybercab, Elon has qualitatively characterized the ramp as agonizingly slow given its new manufacturing process. While production has started, it appears to be more focused on engineering validation and internal testing to prepare for a larger production ramp later this year and into 2027.

Optimus Gen 3 to see higher output by year end

On Optimus Gen 3, we point to media [reporting](#) in China that Tesla has given more concrete procurement requirements to its suppliers in China, and based on that, to reach 1k units per week output by September, and 2k-2.5k per week by year end. Near-term applications include internal factory work: moving parts, loading/unloading, warehouse tasks. Separately, we note that AI5's tape-out appears complete, with Samsung confirming it will be manufacturing AI5 at its Taylor Texas facility using latest 2nm process (which could deliver 40x compute improvement over HW4 and approximately 5x the memory bandwidth). Importantly, Elon confirmed this initial batch will be prioritized by Tesla's supercomputer clusters and the Optimus program first.

Reiterate Buy and \$465 price target

Increasingly so, we think investors are looking at the high possibility of Tesla combining with SpaceX in the near future (next 1-2 years) and what this move could do to the Tesla stock. We suspect this topic could get air time during the upcoming earnings call, how Elon could choose to operate his two separate entities, and what synergies the combination could drive (see our SpaceX initiation [here](#)). Reiterate Buy and \$465 price target.



Appendix 1

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Disclosure checklist			
Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Tesla Inc.	TSLA.OQ	394.76 (USD) 13 Jul 2026	8, 14, 15, 21, 24

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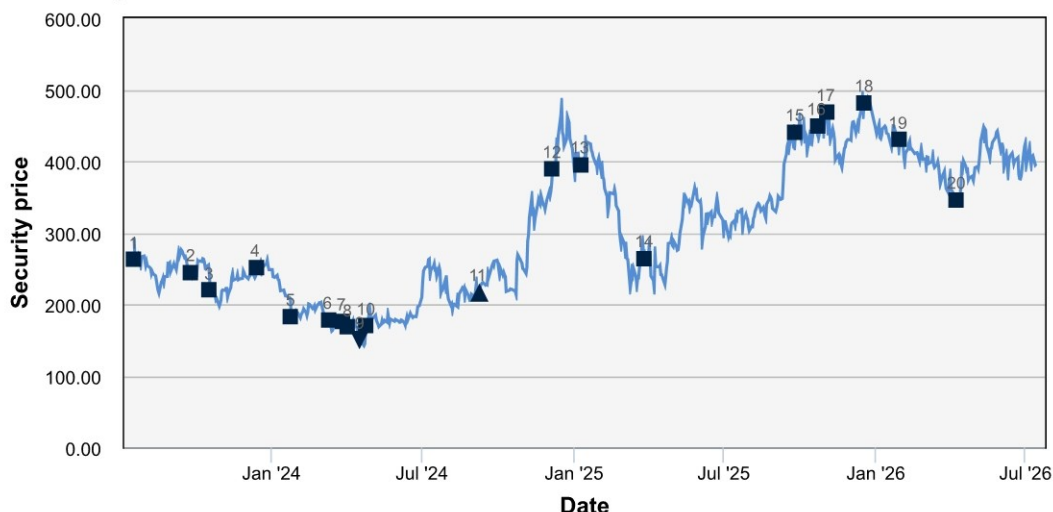
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(as of 07/14/2026)



Current Recommendations

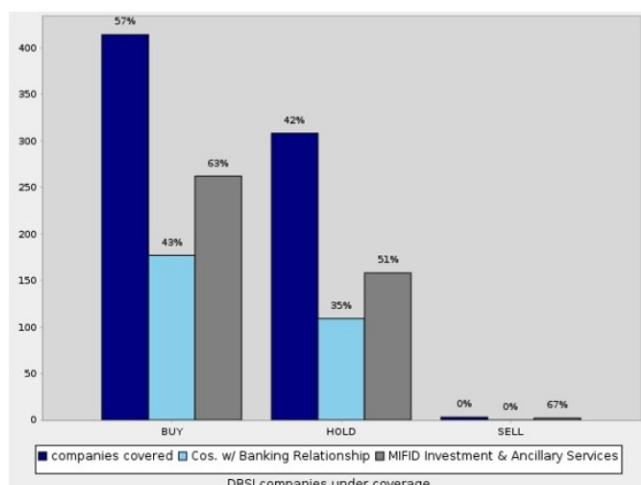
Buy
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Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

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Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



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